

GIVE YOUR AGENTS A GENOME, NOT 57 POST-INSTALL TWEAKS

One version-controlled source can recover the useful parts after a fresh install without preserving every accidental mutation.

THE ACTUAL PROBLEM

A STACK CAN BECOME HARDER TO REPRODUCE

New tools, MCP servers, memory layers and doodads are useful only when their operating knowledge stays inspectable.

- ◆ One-off MCP entries
- ◆ Forgotten tokens
- ◆ Instructions pasted into mystery files

WORKING DEFINITION

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**A CAPABILITY IS A
PREDEFINED PROCEDURE, A
CURATED SET OF TOOLS, AND
ACCESSIBLE DOMAIN
KNOWLEDGE — TOGETHER.**

— Centralized Muscle Memory · author's operating model

ONE SOURCE. DIFFERENT SHAPES.

The goal is not to pretend every harness has the same configuration model.

- ◆ Claude Code → CLAUDE.md + rules/
- ◆ Codex → AGENTS.md
- ◆ Hermes → self-contained AGENTS.md via GitOps

CONFIGURE ADDRESSES. INJECT SECRETS AT RUNTIME.

The sync merges managed wiring into existing state instead of replacing the whole file.

- ◆ No static tokens next to MCP JSON
- ◆ Keep local login state and history intact
- ◆ Update only the plumbing you own

GIT CHANGES THE SOURCE. OPENVIKING HELPS FIND IT.

A search-oriented runtime mirror is useful, but it is not where shared instructions acquire authority.

- ◆ Git: reviewable, version-controlled source
- ◆ OpenViking: browse or retrieve runtime context
- ◆ Skills: copied byte-for-byte; drift is visible

THE RECOVERY PATH SHOULD BE BORING

A bare install has two real prerequisites: the sync and a reachable Cellarette.

- ◆ `npm install`
- ◆ `npm run agents:sync`
- ◆ Recover the working genome, not terminal archaeology

DESIGN QUESTION

WHAT EARNS PERMANENT CITIZENSHIP IN YOUR AGENT STACK?

A capability should survive contact with real work – or be removed from one source file.

◆ DISCUSS / COMPARE / CHALLENGE